

E-OBS and E-OBS_EU product licences

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- **E-OBS** — the dataset covering the **whole of Europe** — is governed by the **E-OBS product licence** (Section 1 below). These data are strictly for use in non-commercial research and education projects only.
- **E-OBS_EU** — the subset covering the **EU area plus Norway, Switzerland, Iceland and the United Kingdom** — is governed by the **Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC-BY 4.0)** licence (Section 2 below). These data may be used for any purpose, including commercial use, provided appropriate attribution is given.

Each licence applies **only to its respective product**. Accepting this combined licence does not extend the restrictions of the E-OBS product licence to the E-OBS_EU product, nor the other way around.

Section 1 — E-OBS product (whole of Europe)

Data Policy for E-OBS

1. Terms and conditions of use

- a) The gridded observational dataset (E-OBS) is available free of charge from the Copernicus Climate Data Store and also from the European Climate Assessment & Dataset (ECA&D).
- b) These data, which include many GCOS-defined Essential Climate Variables (ECVs) for the atmosphere near the surface, are strictly for use in non-commercial research and education projects only. Scientific results based on these data must be submitted for publication in the open literature without delay. If you are unsure about the terms “non-commercial”, “research”, and “education”, please contact the ECA&D Project Team at eca@knmi.nl for clarification.
- c) Although care has been taken in preparing and testing the data products, we cannot guarantee that the data are correct in all circumstances; neither do we accept any liability whatsoever for any error or omission in the data products, their availability, or for any loss or damage arising from their use.
- d) Users should help improve the quality of the data and its delivery by giving feedback where appropriate. Frequent updates are published and a version control system is in place for E-OBS.

2. Citation and acknowledgement

- a) For the success of E-OBS we rely on the cooperation and responsiveness of the participating data holding institutions: National Meteorological and Hydrological Services (NMHSs), observatories and universities. We would like to thank them for kindly agreeing to the release of some or all of their climate data.
- b) Whenever you publish research or applications based in whole or in part on these data, you should include the following citation and acknowledgement:
- c) For E-OBS:

“We acknowledge the E-OBS dataset and the data providers in the ECA&D project (<https://www.ecad.eu>).

Cornes, R., G. van der Schrier, E.J.M. van den Besselaar, and P.D. Jones. 2018: An Ensemble Version of the E-OBS Temperature and Precipitation Datasets, *J. Geophys. Res. Atmos.*, **123**. doi:10.1029/2017JD028200”

3. Rationale

- a) In theory, WMO Resolution 40 on the free exchange of data produced by the NMHSs states that: “As a fundamental principle . . . , WMO commits itself to broadening and enhancing the free and unrestricted international exchange of meteorological and related data and products”.
- b) In practice, there are still large obstacles to data being accessible at the European scale. Even with the formal arrangements for international data exchange in place, there is still a lack of data in international repositories.
- c) The station network for near-surface climate observations in Europe is managed by a large number of (predominantly) NMHSs, each of which has its own data archive and distribution policy. Data policy issues are pertinent for both the historical data and the modern data. Many NMHSs impose conditions and charge a fee for access. This arises from the need to sell the data in order to recoup the costs of making observations and preparing the data. In many countries, the NMHSs are made to cover part of their costs by their respective national governments.
- d) A clear disconnect exists between NMHSs and international institutions such as the IPCC, SUBSTA, UNFCCC and related bodies such as GCOS and the GEO. UNFCCC advocates open access to data and the GEO has set principles for promoting the full and open access to existing databanks in accordance with set principles at no more than the cost of reproduction and distribution. However, these institutions do not enforce anything and leave open the possibility to charge for data by stating that national politics and legislation should be recognized.
- e) The disconnect between NMHSs and international climate change research/policy is illustrated by the so-called Oslo Declaration which has been issued by the directors of the NMHSs in Europe in 2009. The declaration states that: “Recognizing the different funding policies associated

with different economic models for NMHSs and associated different official mandates, the directors of the NMHSs in Europe have reached consensus ... on progressive expansions of their set of essential data made available on a free and unrestricted basis”. However, there is no mention of the international requirements for climate data and the declaration does not specify whether historical daily data (as in ECA&D) are part of the free set.

- f) As a result, our data policy outlined above is a pragmatic compromise between providing full and open access on the one hand, and collecting the largest possible amount of data (and use these data in derived value-added products) on the other hand. We will build upon existing practice, but pursue our efforts for enlarging the quantity of data available within the “downloadable” category in order to guarantee traceability to the source (i.e. the daily observations that were made).
- g) We accept the trade off between transparency and data quantity used for derived products. The reason is that the quality of derived products (such as the E-OBS grids) depends critically on the amount of input data. Restricting these products to only including “downloadable” station data that can be freely exchanged (less than 50% of the total) would be detrimental to the products.
- h) Although not all source data of derived products can be passed onto the users, we do recognize the importance of retaining strong provenance tracking. The details of the “nondownloadable” data used in the derived products are reported and so are the contact points for obtaining these data.

24 August 2011, ECA&D Project Team

Updated: 12 December 2012

16 September 2019

27 January 2020

Section 2 — E-OBS_EU product (EU area plus Norway, Switzerland, Iceland and the United Kingdom)

The E-OBS_EU product is released for use under the **Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC-BY 4.0)** licence.

Highlights and key features of the licence are provided here. Full legal text is provided here.